

Attitudes, Solitude, and AI Use: Who Turns to AI The Most?

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Methods

Seventy-four undergraduate students at a Hispanic-serving institution completed an online survey hosted on Qualtrics in exchange for course credit. Participants completed the following measures: 12-item Attitudes towards Artificial Intelligence Scale (ATTARI-12; Stein et al., 2024), 12-item Preference for Solitude Scale (PSS; Burger, 1995), a single Likert-type question assessing frequency of AI use, and various demographics. Participants were excluded if they failed an attention check question or did not complete one of the required measures, resulting in a reduced sample of 61 participants. Data were analyzed with R. A one-tailed Pearson correlation analysis was used to examine the association between attitudes towards AI and frequency of AI use. After removal of an additional participant (standardized residual > 2), a moderation analysis (Hayes PROCESS) was conducted (n = 60; 5000 bootstrapped samples, controlling for sex) to examine whether this association was moderated by PrS.

Discussion

Our findings support the notion that AI attitudes are positively associated with AI use, explaining 21% of the variance in reported use. We also examined whether those with greater PrS show a stronger link between AI attitudes and use. Although results showed a trend in this direction, the moderation was not statistically significant. Limitations of our pilot study were the relatively homogenous sample and the small sample size that resulted in it being underpowered for a moderation analysis. Future research with a larger and more diverse sample is needed to improve generalizability and validity.

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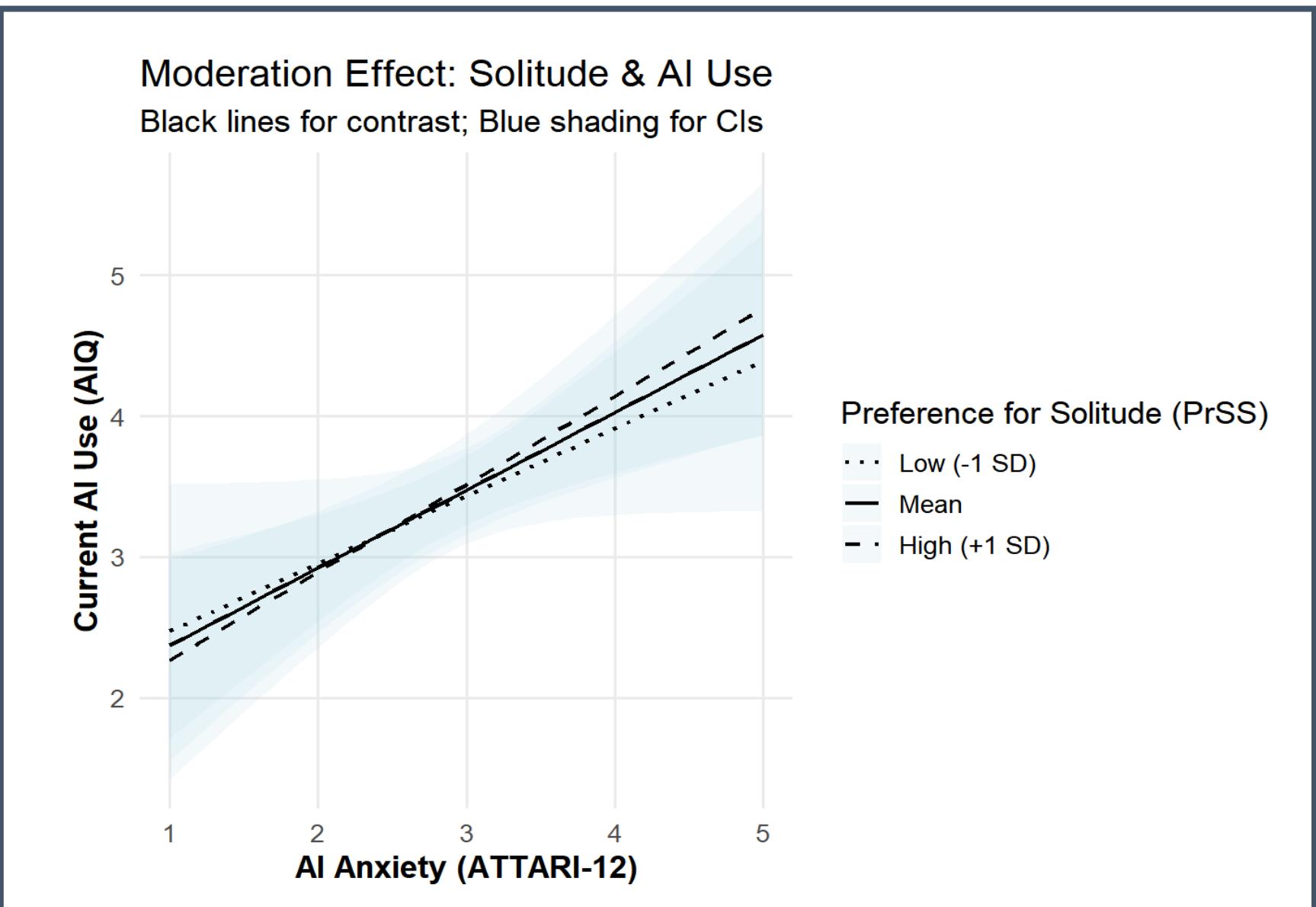
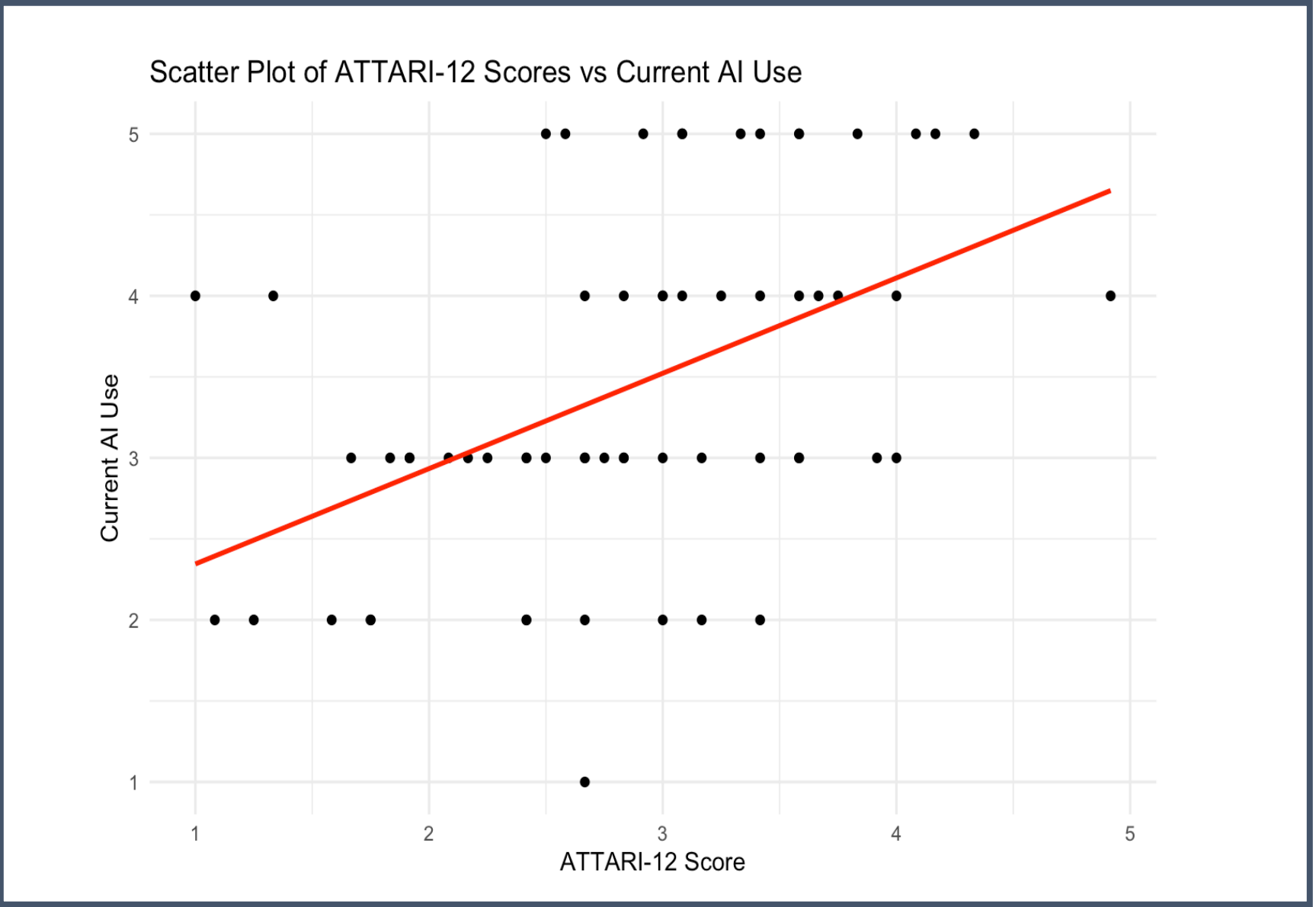
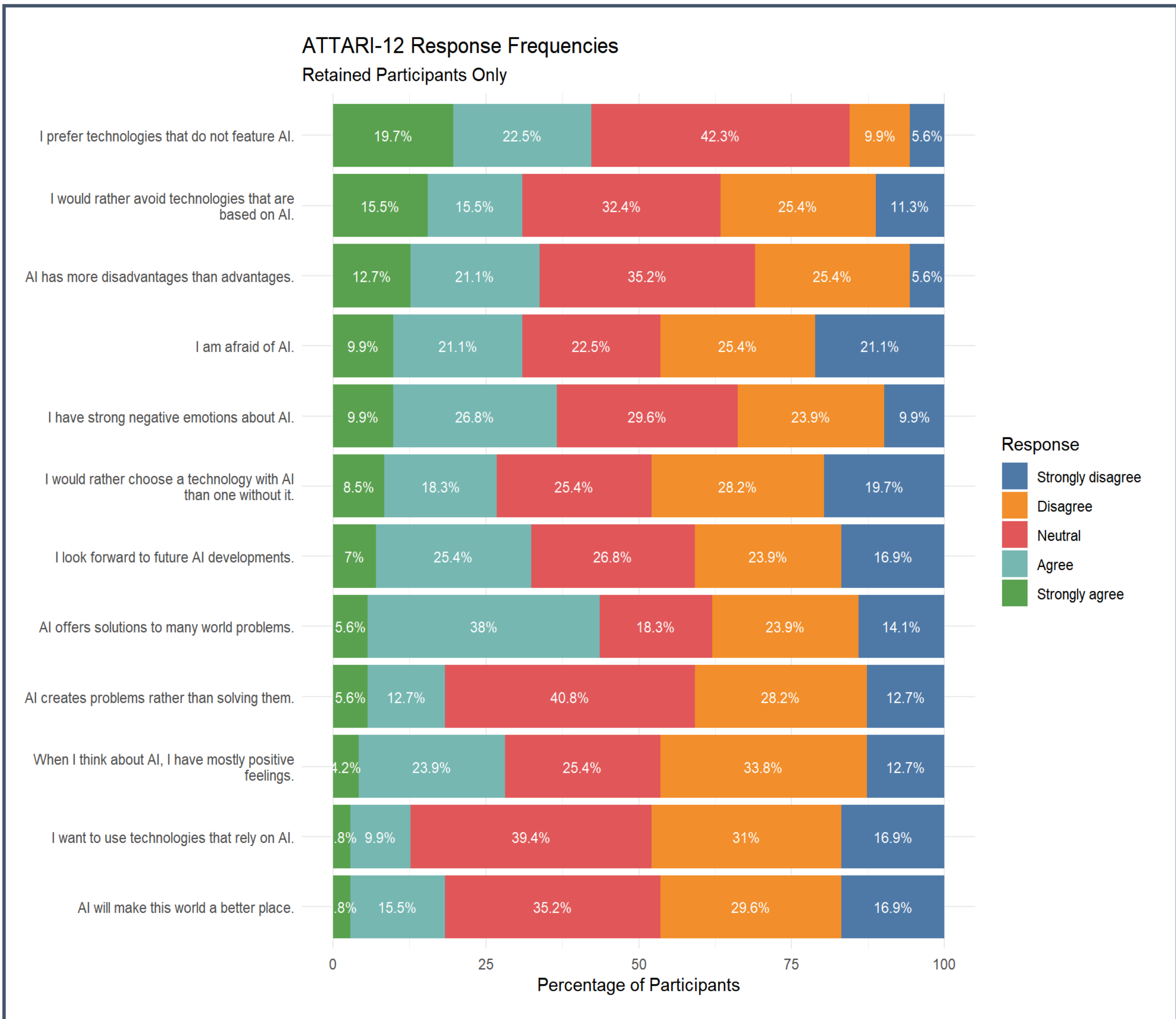
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Introduction

Prior research on attitudes toward artificial intelligence (AI) and actual usage behavior has yielded inconsistent findings, with some studies showing strong predictive links (Li & Wang, 2025) and others finding no direct association (Malka, MacLennan, & De Queiroz, 2025). These inconsistencies suggest a need to examine the AI attitudes–use relationship, including exploration of potential moderators that help identify for whom this association is most likely to emerge. Preference for Solitude (PrS, the tendency to enjoy spending time alone,) may be especially relevant, because AI tools offer a low-demand, independent alternative to seeking help from other people. This pilot study examines whether attitudes toward AI are associated with frequency of AI use and tests whether this association is moderated by PrS. We hypothesized that (i) AI attitudes and AI use will be positively correlated and (ii) that this association is moderated by PrS: greater PrS will amplify the strength of this association, whereas lower PrS will attenuate it.

Results

Forty-three percent of students reported using AI at least once a day and **males reported more positive** attitudes towards AI ($M = 3.23$) than females ($M = 2.61$), $t(43.83) = 2.93, p = .005$. **More favorable attitudes towards AI** were significantly associated with **higher frequency of AI use** ($r(59) = .46, p < .001$). The **entire model**, including AI attitudes, PrS, their interaction, and sex as a covariate, **was significant** $F(4,55) = 5.05, p = .002$. However, **PrS was not shown to be a significant moderator** of this relationship ($\Delta R^2 = .008, F(1,55) = 0.78, p = .381$).



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